

Foxconn and joint venture partner Vedanta zeroed in on Gujarat and Maharashtra; the former managed to walk away with the ₹1.54-lakh crore project this September. Maharashtra lost yet another deal to Gujarat when European aviation major Airbus and the Tatas also selected Gujarat for a ₹22,000-crore aircraft manufacturing facility in October.

This battle amongst states for FDI was never seen before. For instance, Karnataka, the state with the second-largest FDI share, has country corridors—a Japanese industrial township in Tumakuru, and a Taiwan industrial park in Devanahalli.

This June, the government an-

Currently, Invest India is doing the bulk of the hand-holding. For example, Danish wind turbine firm Vestas, which has been present in India since 1989, reached out to Invest India for help in getting some two dozen licences and permits to set up a blade manufacturing unit. It was looking to set up another unit after its positive experience in Gujarat. Vestas finally set up a greenfield manufacturing unit in Chennai with an investment of \$100 million.

The agency claims that the states' contribution is also broad-based, with 31 states and Union territories attracting FDI. "Never before has that happened," says Ba-

has a consumer base is seeing good interest. "There is huge interest in data storage, renewables, and PLI sectors," he says. Mansukh Mandaviya, Minister for Health and Family Affairs, says Invest India has been critical in creating the perfect ecosystem for healthcare investments over many years, "especially during the past 30 months".

The message to foreign investors is very clear. "You have one person to call and we will do the rest," says Bishnoi of Invest India. While the pecking order of the investee countries has remained the same for the past two decades—tax-friendly Mauritius and Singapore are the top

“To change red tape into red carpet, to hand-hold investors, to ease the investor journey, to facilitate investment and to be a one-stop shop, Invest India has done an excellent job towards the Hon’ble PM’s vision of making India the most preferred investment destination in the world”

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nounced Andhra Pradesh, Gujarat, Haryana, Karnataka, Punjab, Tamil Nadu, and Telangana as top achievers based on implementation of the Business Reforms Action Plan, which includes reforms in areas such as the single-window system, land, labour and information access, among others. The changes are visible on the ground. "There are new IPAs in Odisha, UP, and the entire North-East, which never had any investment agency," says Bagla.

The agency also has a dashboard with MoU updates from states. The next stage is a national dashboard.

gla. Meghalaya and Nagaland were amongst the new states receiving investment in FY22. "For me, it is not just the amount. FDI is about trust in India. It's about trust in India's leadership. It's about trust in India's tomorrow. It's about trust in India's opportunity," he says.

Experts say the top four-five states are consolidating their position by cornering a large share of FDI. Mumbai traditionally gets FDI in financial services, Bengaluru gets technology, and Delhi-NCR gets real estate and construction. Bagla suggests that any sector that

two—165 countries have contributed to FDI inflows in FY22.

The agency is now casting a wider net. "Even in the government setup, investors' meetings take precedence over other meetings. The challenge to the team here is to never change the time of an investor meeting," says Bagla. Invest India's office often sees visits by delegations from various countries, political leaders and ambassadors to discuss multiple themes. "The agency has been devoting significant resources towards capacity building and creating a best-in-class investor experience